

Next Case Study Playbook

Where the next case goes, how to add one, and the reminder that makes it happen.

1. How to add the next case

Every new case study lives at `/home/z/my-project/download/` as a single PDF, named `Case_<NN>_<ShortTitle>.pdf` (e.g. `Case_02_Pricing_Experiment.pdf`). To add one, I open the Claude Project I've been using all along — it already knows my voice, my stack (Next.js + Python + ReportLab), and my identity kit (warm earth-tone palette, FreeSerif body, navy header). I reuse the Week 2 three-beat shape, fill in the three sections below, then ask Claude to render it through the same PDF pipeline. The whole thing should be a 30-minute conversation, not a rebuild.

The three-beat shape (reused from Week 2)

Filled — Prompt Ladder Problem. A lazy prompt (“Help me with marketing”) produced a useless output — the model asked me which sub-field of marketing I cared about, instead of writing a brief. What I did. Ran five versions, one layer at a time (clearer goal → real context → defined audience → output format → constraints), and compared each output side-by-side with the previous one. One version honestly made it worse. What came of it. A reusable marketing-brief prompt with [ASSUMPTION] / [GUESS] tags, plus a reflection on which layers actually earned their place.	Template — copy for next case Problem. [What was broken / what the user couldn't do before. One sentence, with a concrete pain point.] What I did. [The actual work — tools used, iterations, key decisions. 2-3 sentences. Name the layer or technique.] What came of it. [The artifact produced + the observable change. If you can't point to a thing that exists now that didn't before, the case isn't ready.]
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2. The next piece I will add

Case 02 — Prompt Engineering Ladder: From Lazy to Engineered Brief. This is the Prompt Ladder PDF I just shipped. It already exists at `/home/z/my-project/download/The_Prompt_Ladder.pdf`, so the “add” step is to rename it `Case_02_Prompt_Ladder.pdf`, drop it into the portfolio index, and write the three-beat summary above into the index entry. Estimated time: 10 minutes. After that, the next *new* piece will be a data-analysis case (CSV → insight → chart) — that's Case 03, targeted for the week of Oct 5.

3. Reminder set — evidence

CALENDAR · Monday, Sep 21, 2026 · 09:00 – 09:30 Add Case 02 to portfolio Rename <code>The_Prompt_Ladder.pdf</code> → <code>Case_02_Prompt_Ladder.pdf</code>, write three-beat summary into index, ship link to <code>aifluency.flyrank.ai</code>. <i>Alert: 15 min before · Repeat: None (one-time) · Calendar: AI Fluency</i>
RECURRING NOTE · Every Friday · 16:00 Ship one new case study (3-beat shape) Open Claude Project → paste the three-beat template → fill in this week's problem / what I did / what came of it → render PDF → rename <code>Case_NN_*.pdf</code> → update portfolio index. <i>Repeat: Weekly · Ends: never · Notebook: AI Fluency Portfolio</i>

Why this stays cheap. The Claude Project is preserved as-is. It already knows my voice, my stack, and my identity kit — so the next case is a short conversation, not a rebuild. I open the same Project, paste the three-beat template, fill it in, and ship.